

POLICY

| ITWORKS | 187

Title

Hardware and Software Maintenance

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It Works Executive

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1 Policy

Ongoing and preventative maintenance for IT WORKS hardware and software will be managed by ICT.

2 Scope

This Policy applies to all IT WORKS staff that support and maintain computer hardware and software for the organisation.

3 Definitions

Change management	A standardized method and procedures for handling changes to minimize the impact of change-related incidents on service quality. Changes are recorded, evaluated, authorized, prioritized, planned, tested, implemented, documented, and reviewed in a controlled manner.
Configuration management	A standardized method and procedures for the managing of ICT assets (Configuration Items). Configuration items are classified, recorded, monitored, controlled, and reported on.

4 Related Policies

ITWORKS/188	ICT Change Management Policy
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5 Policy

The formal process of maintaining hardware and software ensures that a clearly defined set of procedures is used to manage system resources. IT WORKS has a substantial investment in hardware, software, network devices, and peripherals. Proper maintenance and support of these assets increases usability and lowers the total cost of ownership to the organisation. This policy is designed to support preventative and ongoing maintenance of IT WORKS computer and software assets.

5.1 General

Hardware and software maintenance and support arrangements shall be required for all standard and non-standard desktops, servers, network infrastructure equipment, peripherals, and related software. This shall include applications and systems that are subject to their own proprietary maintenance and upgrade policies. Service, maintenance, and support shall be properly staffed and managed through a ticket management system and service desk.

5.2 Computer and network hardware

IT WORKS management and the IT WORKS service desk shall ensure:

- All infrastructure desktops, servers, peripherals, and network hardware (switches, routers, firewalls) are covered by on-site warranty agreements with appropriate response times to meet business continuity needs
- Defective items under warranty are repaired in a timely fashion
- Repairs or surplus of equipment not covered under current warranty meet all IT WORKS protocols and procedures

The IT WORKS ICT staff under the direction of the Service Delivery Manager shall centrally procure and install all network and departmental computer hardware including but not limited to desktops, servers, audio-visual, security, laptops, printers, scanners, monitors, keyboards, and mice. This shall ensure:

- The equipment is compatible with existing IT WORKS hardware and software
- Hardware and software standards are enforced
- Centralized purchasing supplies the best price for goods
- Equipment is covered under appropriate warranty and maintenance support agreements
- Configuration management and security policy implementation are consistent and minimize organizational risks
- The equipment is properly configured and has appropriate security controls/software

5.3 System and application software

For this policy, computer software shall include:

- Operating systems, virtualization, firmware, and related software
- Major applications such as general financials and ERP, CMS, service management systems, email, and related databases/interfaces
- Office productivity software including spreadsheets, word processing, presentation, etc.
- Third-party utility and productivity applications such as Internet browsers, Adobe Acrobat Reader, media players, archive tools, etc.
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ICT shall be responsible for the installation and maintenance of all IT WORKS software. ICT under the direction of the Service Delivery Manager shall:

- Develop configuration standards for all system components that address all known security vulnerabilities and are consistent with industry-accepted definitions
- Periodically update system configuration standards as new vulnerabilities are identified
- Install and maintain system and end-user software
- Maintain appropriate software license records for compliance purposes
- Fully test applications to ensure they are compatible with and run on standard [LEP] hardware
- Subscribe to vendor software maintenance programs where appropriate and applicable
- Tune and analyze operational software configurations for optimum performance
- Security protection software such as firewalls, anti-malware, antivirus, etc.
- Utilities and other tools
- Update critical system patches within 30 days of release
- Patches shall be tested before deployment to production environments
- Ensure third-party vendors and contractors work in conjunction with ICT Services and uphold all policies and procedures

Individuals seeking exceptions to this policy must seek approval from IT WORKS management and the Service Delivery Manager **PRIOR** to purchasing any specialized, non-standard hardware, software, or equipment. Support for non-standard hardware, software, or other equipment shall be assessed and agreed upon on a case-by-case basis by the Service Delivery Manager.

6 Audit Controls and Management

On-demand documented procedures and evidence of practice should be in place for this operational policy as part of IT WORKS internal processes and procedures. Audit control and management evidence include:

- Documented hardware and software standards with evidence of regular review and update
- Asset and software management and tracking systems and tools
- Hardware and software configuration standards, tools, and orderly system builds
- Exception logs for user standards hardware/software deviation
- Regular and operational demonstration of patch, change, and configuration management processes and procedures/notifications

7 Enforcement

Staff members found in policy violation may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

8 Distribution

This policy is to be distributed to all IT WORKS staff and contractors using IT WORKS information resources.